

Introduction

This report presents an analysis of Northwind Trading Company's sales performance across its global operations. Covering 2,155 orders, this report examines revenue generation, profitability, product category performance, customer behaviour, and logistics efficiency.

Northwind Trading Company operates across 21 countries, distributing eight product categories ranging from Beverages, Dairy Products, Meat & Poultry, Condiments, Produce, Grains & Cereals, Seafood and Confections. The company works with three shipping partners and serves a diverse customer base spanning Europe, the Americas, and beyond.

Key areas of focus include geographic market performance, seasonal revenue trends, top-performing products and customers, and delivery reliability.

Findings & Insights

Overall Financial Performance

Northwind generated total sales revenue of approximately \$1.35 million across the reporting period, with net sales of \$1.27 million and total profit of \$1.06 million, representing a healthy overall profit margin of approximately 83.5% on net sales.

Geographic Performance

The United States is the single largest market by both revenue and profit, contributing \$199,419 in profit against \$263,567 in revenue. Germany closely follows as the second most profitable market at \$192,114, while Austria ranks third. Together, the top three markets include USA, Germany, and Austria, which accounts for approximately 46% of total profit.

At the other end of the scale, markets such as Poland (\$3,070 profit), Norway (\$4,838), and Argentina (\$6,346) contribute minimally and may need a review relative to the cost of servicing them.

Monthly Revenue Trend

April was the strongest single month at approximately \$176,832 in net sales, while January also performed strongly at \$155,480. There is a pronounced mid-year dip, with June recording the lowest monthly revenue at just \$36,363, less than a quarter of April's figure. Revenue recovers from July onwards, peaking again in December at \$116,638.

Product Category Performance

Beverages is the highest-grossing product category, generating \$286,527 in sales revenue, followed by Dairy Products at \$251,331 and Meat & Poultry at \$178,189. Grains & Cereals is the weakest performer at \$100,727, though the gap between the bottom two categories is relatively narrow, suggesting broadly balanced demand across the portfolio.

Top Products by Revenue

At the individual product level, Cote de Blaye stands out dramatically as the top-selling product with \$149,984 in revenue, nearly double the second-ranked product, Thuringer Rostbratwurst (\$87,736). Raclette Courdavault and Camembert Pierrot also feature prominently, reflecting the strength of premium European food products in the portfolio.

Top Customers by Revenue

The top three customers were QUICK, SAVEA, and ERNSH, collectively accounting for \$346,394 in sales revenue, representing approximately 25.6% of total revenue. The loss of any one of these accounts would have a negative impact on overall performance.

Delivery & Logistic Performance

Of 2,155 total orders, the vast majority (1,990 — 92.3%) were delivered on time. However, 92 orders (4.3%) arrived late and 73 (3.4%) had not been shipped at the time of data capture. While on-time performance is strong overall, the volume of unshipped orders is a concern.

Among shippers, United Package handles the largest volume (864 orders), followed closely by Speedy Express (646) and Federal Shipping (645). The difference between Speedy Express and Federal Shipping suggests both are used interchangeably, while United Package carries a greater share of the load.

Recommendations

Prioritise & Protect Key Markets

The USA and Germany together account for nearly 37% of total profit. Northwind should deploy dedicated account management and tailored commercial terms in these markets to protect and grow this revenue base.

Consider conducting a formal market review of underperforming regions like Poland, Norway, and Argentina to assess whether continued investment is justified or whether resources could be redeployed more productively elsewhere.

Address Mid-Year Revenue Dip

The dramatic fall in revenue between April and June (from \$176,832 to \$36,363) warrants investigation. This may reflect seasonal buying patterns, order timing, or supply-side constraints.

Invest in High-Performing Categories & Products

Beverages and Dairy Products together account for over 40% of sales revenue.

Northwind should ensure sufficient inventory, supplier relationships, and marketing support for these categories to sustain their leading position.

Cote de Blaye's outsized revenue contribution (\$149,984) suggests there may be scope to expand the premium product range.

Reduce Customer Concentration Risk

With three customers accounting for over 25% of revenue, Northwind carries significant concentration risk. Targeting mid-tier buyers in key markets would help diversify the revenue base.

Improve Logistics

The 73 unshipped orders at the time of the data snapshot should be investigated as a priority. A root cause analysis would determine whether this reflects capacity constraints, process failures, or data quality issues.

Given United Package's dominant order volume (864 vs 645 for each competitor), Northwind should consider whether workload is being appropriately distributed and whether over-reliance on a single carrier creates delivery risk.